

Understanding the Indian camera industry



To more aware camera buyers, increasing count of DSLRs being sold, smartphones eating into compact camera sales and more, Mr. Andrew Koh, Vice President of Canon India's Consumer Imaging and Information Centre, tells us how India has developed in the field of photography.

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1 Do online stores make higher sales, or are offline stores still more important?

For now, offline markets still have a bigger share, although online is catching up. We like to believe that we can have a good balance of both.

1 Ranging from entry-segment digital cameras to professional cameras like the Canon 1DX Mark II, which happen to be the most popular?

The entry-segment of DSLR cameras has seen growth recently and remains the most popular, with a lot of first-time buyers entering the market. For instance, the Canon EOS 1300D is doing very well, and is aimed at first-time buyers. At the same, we have seen consistency in more professional cameras, as pro buyers are increasing and photographers are becoming more sophisticated. These buyers really know what they want, and are going for slightly higher level of cameras like the EOS 80D or even the EOS 5D Mark III.

1 How are mirrorless cameras performing in Indian market?

For now, it is still a very small market, although we do provide our users with an option to choose a Canon mirrorless camera with the EOS M3 and EOS M10.

1 A lot of DSLRs and professional cameras nowadays come with touch input, Wi-Fi, GPS and the likes. How big an impact do they have on the buying decision of camera users?

Wi-Fi is indeed an attractive and con-



Andrew Koh, Vice President, Canon India's Consumer Imaging and Information Centre

venient option, and that is why we are including it on our newer line of cameras like the EOS 1300D. We are constantly trying to evolve our product lineup to be in touch with the recent trends. Touchscreen is also very useful, and touch focus is a nifty addition to cameras. Seeing that you are so used to using touchscreen all the time with our smartphones, it is very easy to use and own.

1 Talking about touchscreen, smartphone cameras have been steadily improving, and are impacting the entry-segment compact digital camera market. What do you have to say about this?

Yes, I agree that smartphone photography has impacted the entry segment cameras, and I don't think that you can deny it any longer. But, with that, what we have seen are users directly making a

jump to DSLRs, instead of first choosing a digital camera and then progressing gradually. While smartphones do get you interested in photography, once you start using it, you realise the restrictions that such imaging has, which is increasing the number of people opting for a DSLR who get interested in photography and then wish to be more advanced.

1 Are there any specific lineup that Canon is thinking about to retain buyers for compact cameras?

We have been observing the trend, and buyers of compact cameras nowadays prefer high zoom. This is important and smartphones cannot do this as of now. So we are targeting at providing compact cameras with more advanced features, as you will find in Canon's G-series of compact cameras. They have more manual controls and better image sensors, hence, being better cameras beyond smartphone photography.

1 What do you think are the key differences between the Indian camera buyers and the more advanced markets?

It will not be very fair to compare, but for perspective, in markets like Japan, every family usually has three or four cameras, and naturally, this leads to more sales of compact or mirrorless cameras. In India, a lot of families may not even have a dedicated camera and are on the verge of buying their first cameras. On the other end, there are professional photographers who know exactly which camera to buy. The markets internationally are more balanced, while India is still growing. 

Full interview at: <http://digit.in/CanonIn>